

Wallace's flying frog

Rhacophorus nigropalmatus

Named after its discoverer A.R. Wallace, the English naturalist who developed the theory of evolution with Charles Darwin, the flying frog is a perfect example of how species can adapt to their environments. The webbed feet used for swimming by the frog's ancestors are repurposed as parachutes, allowing it to leap long

distances between trees. Adults need never come down to the ground—they can leap away from predators or toward new feeding areas. During the rainy season, eggs are laid inside a foam nest whipped up on a branch from the female's mucus secretions. When the tadpoles hatch, they fall into a pond or waterhole below.

▷ GROUNDED FROGLET

Juvenile froglets have brown granular skin more suited to life among mud and soil than the smooth green skin of the tree-living adult.



↔ 3–4 in (8–10 cm)

☁ Rainy season

⊗ Locally common

🕸 Insects, spiders

🏠



SE. Asia

◁ PARACHUTING ADULT

The splayed webbed feet allow Wallace's flying frogs to make leaps up to 50 ft (15 m). Large toe pads provide a strong grip on landing.

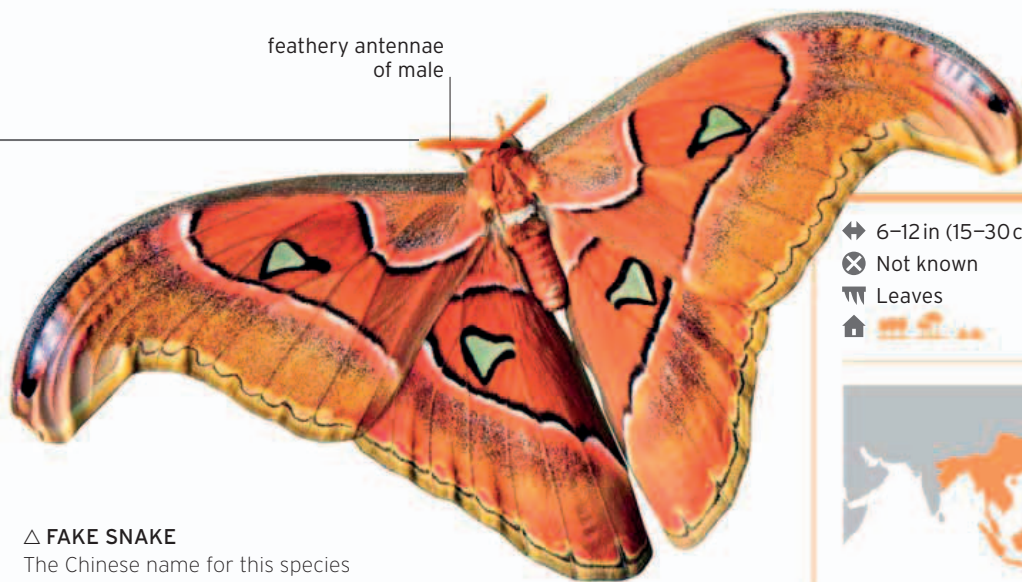
Atlas moth

Attacus atlas

Named after the Greek demigod who carried the world on his shoulders, this species once held the title of the largest living moth; however, the Hercules moth of New Guinea and Australia has the biggest wing area of all. Nevertheless, the female Atlas moth can cover a dinner plate (the males are smaller).

Adult Atlas moths do not feed, and they live for a week at most, so they need to breed as soon as possible; males can track the scent of females several miles away with their feathery antennae. The females lay around 250 tiny eggs on the underside of leaves, particularly of citrus and other fruit trees.

feathery antennae of male



△ FAKE SNAKE

The Chinese name for this species is snakehead moth because its curved wingtips look like the head of a threatening cobra.

↔ 6–12 in (15–30 cm)

⊗ Not known

🌿 Leaves

🏠



S., SE., and E. Asia